Ingredient Safety Reference

A 425-ingredient guide to what's actually in her products.

Dr. Nina-Marie, ND · doctorninamarie.com

This is the master reference I use to audit every product that touches my daughter's skin and hair. It's the same reference behind The Puberty Shelf and The Curly Hair Shelf. **If you can read a label and recognize the ingredients in this list, you can protect your daughter's hormones during the most vulnerable years of her life.**

Every ingredient is sorted by risk category. The "Watch for" column shows the chemical family or naming pattern, so you can spot relatives even when the exact name is different.

425
Ingredients audited across 8 risk categories

128
Low-tox ingredients you can trust

297
Ingredients flagged for at least one concern

Risk Category Key

- 1 **Carcinogen**
- 2 **Endocrine Disruption**
- 3 **Heavy Metals** (bio-accumulation)
- 4 **Allergies, Irritation, Corrosion**
- 5 **Microbiome-Busting** (skin barrier)
- 6 **Microplastics** (non-biodegradable)
- 7 **Acutely Toxic**
- 8 **Respiratory Irritant**, asthmagen
- LOW TOX **Low Tox** — safe alternatives

How to use this reference

1. Scan a product label and look up anything you don't recognize in the alphabetized table.
2. The numbered badges tell you which risk categories apply. More badges, more flags.
3. The "Watch for" column shows the naming pattern. If something ends in "-nium," "-eth," "-paraben," or contains "fragrance," it's likely flagged.
4. LOW TOX = trusted alternatives.

Educational only, not medical advice. Always verify current product formulations.

© Dr. Nina-Marie, ND · doctorninamarie.com

The Reference Table

All 425 ingredients · alphabetical

INGREDIENT	CONCERNS	WATCH FOR / NOTES
1.2 benzisothiazol-3(2h)-one	4 7	
2-bromo-2-nitropropane-1,3-diol	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *Bromopol*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
2-butoxyethanol	2	**Watch for: *-oxyethanol*** *Same as butoxyethanol*
2-ethoxyethanol	2	**Watch for: *-oxyethanol***
2-methoxyethanol	2	**Watch for: *-oxyethanol***
2-methyl-2h-isothizole-3-one	4 7	
5-Bromo-5-nitro-1,3-dioxane	1 4	*Formaldehyde*
Acetic acid (vinegar)	8	*Avoid inhaling fumes; ensure adequate ventilation*
Acrylamide	1	**Watch for: "*-acrylamide*"**
Acrylates copolymer	1 2 4 6	*PFAS treated*
Acrylic acid	1 4 6	
Alkoxylated Amine Substituted Triaryl Methane	1	*Alkoxylate*
Alkyl (50% C14, 40% C12, 10% C16) dimethyl benzyl ammonium chloride	2	**Watch for: *-nium*** *Quat*
Alkyl C12-14 Dimethylethylbenzyl Ammonium Chloride	2	**Watch for: *-nium*** *Quat*
Alkyl C12-18 Dimethylbenzyl Ammonium Chloride	2	**Watch for: *-nium*** *Quat*
Allantoin	LOW TOX	
Aluminum	3	
Aluminum Hydroxide	4	
Aluminum starch octenylsuccinate	2 3	
Aminopropyl Diglycol Dimaleate	4	**Watch for: "*-glycol*"**
Ammonia	4 8	
Ammonium Acryloyldimethyltaurate/VP Copolymer	1 6	**Watch for: "*Vinyl-*"** *Vinyl*
Ammonium cocoyl isethionate	1	**Watch for: *isethionate*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Amyl cinnamal	4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Amylase	8	*Enzyme; Avoid in powdered products as much as possible*
Anisinic acid	LOW TOX	
Arsenic	1 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #***
Ascorbic acid (Vitamin C)	LOW TOX	**Watch for: "*Ascorb-*"**
Avobenzone	2	
Behenalkonium betaine	2	**Watch for: *-nium***
Behentrimonium methosulfate	LOW TOX	
Behentrimonium sulfate	2 4	**Watch for: "*-nium*" *and* "*-sulfate*"**
Behenyl alcohol	LOW TOX	**Watch for: "*-alcohol*"**
Bentonite clay	LOW TOX	

Benzalkonium chloride	2 4 8	
Benzethonium chloride	2 4 8	
Benzisothiazolinone	2 4 5 8	*Suspected endocrine disruptor*
Benzophenone- 1, 2, 3 ,4, 5, or 9	2	**Watch for: *Benzophenone- #***
Benzyl alcohol	LOW TOX	
Benzylhemiformal	1 4	*Formaldehyde*
Benzylparaben	2 4	
Beta-myrcene	1 4 8	**Watch for: *(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum***
Betaine	LOW TOX	
BHA (butylated hydroxyanisole)	1 2	
BHT (butylated hydroxytoluene)	1 2	
Bisabolol	4	*From chamomile plants*
Bleach	4 7 8	*Same as "sodium hypochlorite"*
Brassica alcohol	LOW TOX	
Brassica Glycerides	LOW TOX	
Brassicyl Isoleucinate Esylate	LOW TOX	
Brassicyl valinate esylate	LOW TOX	
Butoxyethanol	2	**Watch for: *-oxyethanol*** *Same as 2-butoxyethanol*
Butyl Acetate	4 8	**Watch for: *(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum***
Butylene glycol	1 2	**Watch for: *-glycol***
Butyloctyl Salicylate	2	
Butylparaben	2 4	
Butylphenyl methylpropional	2	*Same as lilial*
C10 16-Alkyldimethyl	2	
C10-16 alkyldimethylamine oxide	1 2	**Watch for: *-amine***
C10-16 pareth	1	**Watch for: *-eth*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
C12-16 alcohols ethoxylated propoxylated	1	**Watch for: *-ethoxylated*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
C12-18 Ethoxylated alcohols	1	**Watch for: *-ethoxylated*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
C6-12 ethoxylated alcohols	1	**Watch for: *-ethoxylated*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
C9-11 Alkyl Glucoside	LOW TOX	
Cadmium	1 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #***
Caffeine	LOW TOX	
calcium formate	LOW TOX	
Calcium gluconate	LOW TOX	
Calomel	1 3	
Capryleth-4	1	**Watch for: *-eth*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Caprylhydroxamic acid	LOW TOX	

Capryloyl glycerin/sebacic acid copolymer	LOW TOX	
Caprylyl Glycol	LOW TOX	
Carbomer	1 4 6	
Carnauba Starch	LOW TOX	
Cashmeran (DPMI)	1 4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"** *Musk-type compound*
Celestolide (ABDI)	1 4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"** *Musk-type compound*
Cellulase	8	*Enzyme; Avoid in powdered products as much as possible*
Cellulose gum	LOW TOX	
Ceramide	LOW TOX	
Ceteareth	1 4 5	**Watch for: *-eth*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Cetearyl alcohol	LOW TOX	**Watch for: "*-alcohol*"**
Cetearyl glucoside	LOW TOX	**Watch for: *-glucoside*"**
Cetearyl olivate	LOW TOX	
Cetrimonium chloride	2	**Watch for: *-nium***
Cetyl alcohol	LOW TOX	
Cetyl palmitate	LOW TOX	
Cetyl pyridinium chloride	2	**Watch for: *-nium***
Chloromethylisothiazolinone	4 5 8	
Chlorphenesin	4	
CI 42090 (Blue 1)	1 2 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #*** *PFAS treated*
CI 77007 (Ultramarines)	1 2 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #*** *PFAS treated*
CI 77491 (Red Iron Oxide)	1 2 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #*** *PFAS treated*
CI 77492 (Yellow Iron Oxide)	1 2 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #*** *PFAS treated*
CI 77499 (Black Iron Oxide)	1 2 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #*** *PFAS treated*
CI 77891 (Titanium Dioxide)	1 2 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #*** *PFAS treated; Not a concern in cream-based skincare or makeup; avoid in sprays, aerosols, powders, and oral care*
Cinnamal	4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Citral	4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Citric acid	LOW TOX	
Citronellal	4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Cocamide DEA	1 4	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
Cocamide MEA	1 4	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
Cocamidopropyl betaine	1 4	**Watch for: *-amidopropyl*** *Nitrosamines*
Cocamidopropyl hydroxysultaine	1 4	**Watch for: *-amidopropyl*** *Nitrosamines*
Cocamidopropylamine Oxide	1 4	**Watch for: *-amidopropyl*** *Nitrosamines*

Coco-glucoside	LOW TOX	**Watch for: *-glucoside*"**
Coconut acid	LOW TOX	
Coconut alkanes (aka coco- caprylate)	LOW TOX	
Coconut oil	LOW TOX	
Copper	LOW TOX	
Coumarin	4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Cyclomethicone	1 2 6	**Watch for: -"*siloxane*"** *PFAS treated*
Cyclopentasiloxane	1 2 6	**Watch for: -"*siloxane*"** *PFAS treated*
Cyclotetrasiloxane	1 2 6	**Watch for: -"*siloxane*"** *PFAS treated*
DEA Oleth-3 Phosphate	1 4	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
DEA-Cetyl Phosphate	1 4	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
Decanal	4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Decyl-glucoside	LOW TOX	**Watch for: *-glucoside*"**
Dehydroacetic acid	LOW TOX	
Denatonium Benzoate	4 7	
Di(2-ethylhexyl) phthalate (DEHP)	2	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Di-n-butyl phthalate (DnBP)	2	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Diazolidinylurea	1 2 4 5	*Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Dicetyldimonium chloride	2	**Watch for: *-nium***
Diethanolamine (DEA)	1 4	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
Diethyl phthalate (DEP)	2	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Diethylamino Hydroxybenzoyl Hexyl Benzoate	4	*contamination with phthalates (German Federal Institute for Risk Assessment)*
Diethylhexyl sodium sulfosuccinate	5	
Diheptyl succinate	LOW TOX	
Dihydrogenated tallow benzylmonium chloride	2	**Watch for: *-nium***
Diisobutyl phthalate (DiBP)	2	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Dimethicone	2 6	*PFAS treated*
Dimethicone/vinyl dimethicone crosspolymer	1	**Watch for: *-crosspolymer*** *vinyl formamide*
Dimethyl phthalate (DMP)	2	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Dimethylimidazolidinone Rice Starch	2	
Dipalmitoyl Hydroxyproline	LOW TOX	
Dipropylene glycol	2	*glycol ether*
Dipropylene glycol butyl ether	2	*glycol ether*
Disodium cocoamphodiacetate	LOW TOX	
Disodium Decyl Phenyl Ether Disulfonate	4 7	

Disodium distyrylbiphenyl disulfonate	7	
Disodium laurimidodiproprionate	4	
Disteardimonium Hectorite	2	**Watch for: *-num*** *PFAS treated*
DMDM hydantoin	1 2 4 5	*Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Dodecyl Phenol Ethoxylate	1 2	*1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
EDTA	4	**Watch for: "*-EDTA*"**
Estragole	1 4 8	**Watch for: *(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum***
Ethanolamine	4	
Ethyl Acetate	4	
Ethylene glycol	1 2	**Watch for: *-glycol***
Ethylhexyl palmitate	LOW TOX	
Ethylhexylglycerin	4 5	
Ethylparaben	2 4	
Eugenol	4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Farnesol	4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Fragrance/Parfum	1 2 4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"** *carcinogens, phthalates, allergens*
Furanone	4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
galaxolide (HHCB)	1 4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"** *Musk-type compound*
Geraniol	4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Gluconic acid	LOW TOX	
Glutathione	LOW TOX	
Glyceryl caprylate	LOW TOX	
Glyceryl oleate	LOW TOX	
Glyceryl stearate SE	LOW TOX	
Glycol Distearate	4	**Watch for: "*-glycol*"**
Glycolipids	LOW TOX	
Glyoxal	1 2 4 5	*Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Glyoxylic acid	2	*Liver, kidney, and lung damage*
Goldenseal extract - hydrastis canadensis	LOW TOX	
Grape Alcohol	LOW TOX	
Grapefruit Seed Extract	2 4 5	*benzethonium chloride, methylparaben, and benzalkonium chloride contamination (PMID: 16719494)*
Guar hydroxypropyltrimonium chloride	2	**Watch for: *-nium***
Heptyl undecylenate	LOW TOX	
Hexoxyethanol	1 5	*Kidney, reproductive, and developmental toxicity*
Hexylene glycol	1 2	**Watch for: *-glycol***
Homosalate	2	
Hyaluronic acid	LOW TOX	
Hydroquinone	1	**Watch for: "*-hydroquinone*"**

Hydroquinone	1	Watch for: *"-hydroquinone*
Hydroxycitronellal	4 8	Watch for: *"(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum"*
Hydroxyethyl Urea	4	
Hydroxyethylcellulose	LOW TOX	
Hydroxyethylpiperazine Ethane Sulfonic Acid	4	
Hydroxypropyltrimonium Chloride	2	Watch for: *-nium*
Imidazolidinylurea	1 2 4 5	*Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Inulin	LOW TOX	
Ionone	4 8	Watch for: *"(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum"*
Isoamyl Laurate	LOW TOX	
Isobutylparaben	2 4	
Isocetyl Stearoyl Stearate	LOW TOX	
Isododecane	1 2	*PFAS treated*
Isoeugenol	4 8	Watch for: *"(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum"*
Jojoba Beads	LOW TOX	
Jojoba Wax	LOW TOX	
Kaolin	LOW TOX	
Lactobacillus	LOW TOX	
Lauramide DEA	1 4	Watch for: *-EA* *Nitrosamines*
Lauramidopropyl Betaine	1 4	Watch for: *-amidopropyl* *Nitrosamines*
Lauramine oxide	4 5	
Laureth-23	1 4 5	Watch for: *-eth* *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Laureth-4	1 4 5	Watch for: *-eth* *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Laureth-6	1 4 5	Watch for: *-eth* *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Lauroyl lysine	LOW TOX	
Lauryl glucosides hydroxypropylsulfonate	LOW TOX	
Lauryl-glucoside	LOW TOX	Watch for: *-glucoside"*
Lead	1 3	Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #*
Leuconostoc/radish root ferment filtrate	LOW TOX	
Lilial	2 4 8	Watch for: *"(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum"* *Musk-type compound*
Limonene	4 8	Watch for: *"(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum"*
Linalool	4 8	Watch for: *"(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum"*
Linoleamide MEA	1 4	Watch for: *-EA* *Nitrosamines*
Lipase	LOW TOX	
Magnesium chloride	LOW TOX	
Magnesium sulfate	LOW TOX	
Mannase	LOW TOX	

MEA C10-16 Alkylbenzenesulfonate	1	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
MEA Laureth Sulfate	1	**Watch for: *-EA, -eth*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide; Nitrosamines*
Mercuric	1 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #***
Mercurio	1 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #***
Mercurous chloride	1 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #***
Mercury	1 3	**Watch for: *FD&C #; D&C #, CI #***
Methenamine	1 4	*Formaldehyde*
Methicone	1 2 6	*PFAS treated*
Methyl di-t-butyl hydroxyhydrocinnamate	2	
Methyl isobutyl ketone (MIBK)	1 8	**Watch for: *(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum***
methyl-N-methylanthranilate	1 8	**Watch for: *(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum***
Methylchloroisothiazolinone	4 5	
Methylene glycol	1 2	**Watch for: *-glycol***
Methyleugenol	1 8	**Watch for: *(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum***
Methylisothiazolinone	4 5	
Methylparaben	2 4	
Mica	1 4	*May be PFAS treated; Not a concern if it is not the first or main ingredient.*
Mineral oil	1	
Monoethanolamine	1	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
Musk	1 4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Myrcene	1 4	
Myristamide DEA	1 4	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
Myristyl Myristate	LOW TOX	
N-alkyl ethylbenzyl dimethyl ammonium (c12-c14)	4	**Watch for: "*-nium*"** *Quat*
Naphthalene	1 8	**Watch for: *(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum***
Niacinamide (Vitamin B3)	LOW TOX	
nitrosamine-n- nitrosoethanolamine (NDELA)	1	
Nonoxynol	2	**Watch for: *Nonoxynol- #***
Nonyl Phenol Ethoxylate	1 2	*1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Nylon-12	1 2 6	*PFAS treated*
Octinoxate	2	
Octisalate	2	
Octocrylene	2	
Octyl Phenol Ethoxylate	1 2	*1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Octyl/decyl glucoside	LOW TOX	
Octylisothiazolinone	4 5 8	

Oleamide DEA	1 4	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
Oleic acid	LOW TOX	
Olive oil polyglyceryl-6 esters	LOW TOX	
Oxybenzone	2	
p-anisic acid	LOW TOX	
Panthenol	LOW TOX	
para amino-benzoic acid (PABA)	2	
Paraffin	1	
Paraffinum liquidum	1	
Paraformaldehyde	1 4	*Formaldehyde*
PEG PPG ethylhexyl ether	1 2 4 5	*1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
PEG-10 Dimethicone	2	*1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide; PFAS treated*
PEG-20 sorbitan cocoate	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *PEG- # sorbitan*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
PEG-20 sorbitan oleate	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *PEG- # sorbitan*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
PEG-40 sorbitan diisostearate	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *PEG- # sorbitan*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
PEG-40 sorbitan oleate	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *PEG- # sorbitan*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
PEG-6 methyl ether	1 4	**Watch for: *PEG- #*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Pentaerythrityl Distearate	LOW TOX	
Pentaerythrityl Tetra-Di-T-Butyl Hydroxyhydrocinnamate	1	*Antioxidant*
Pentasodium Pentetate	2	
Pentylene glycol	1 2	**Watch for: *-glycol***
perfluorohexylethyl triethoxysilane	1 2	*PFAS, synthetic silicone*
Perfluorononyl dimethicone/methicone/amodimet hicone crosspolymer	1 2	**Watch for: *-crosspolymer*** *PFAS, synthetic silicone*
Petrolatum	1	
Petroleum	1	
Phantolide (AHDI)	1 4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"** *Musk-type compound*
Phenethyl alcohol	4 5 8	*Similar to phenoxyethanol*
Phenol Ethoxylate	1 2	*alkylphenol ethoxylate*
Phenoxyethanol	1 2 4 5 8	**Watch for: *-oxyethanol*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide, fragrance chemical*
Phenoxyisopropanol	7	
Phytic Acid	LOW TOX	
Poloxamer	1	**Watch for: "*Poloxamer- #*"** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide, propylene oxide*
Poly (oxy-1,2-ethanediyl), alpha- (4-nonylphenyl)-omega-hydroxy-	1 2	*alkylphenol ethoxylate*
Poly (oxy-1,2-ethanediyl), alpha- (4-nonylphenyl)-omega-hydroxy-, branche	1 2	*alkylphenol ethoxylate*

Poly (oxy-1,2-ethanediyl), alpha-(isononylphenyl)-omega-hydroxy-	1 2	*alkylphenol ethoxylate*
Poly (oxy-1,2-ethanediyl), alpha-(nonylphenyl)-omega-hydroxy	1 2	*alkylphenol ethoxylate*
Poly (oxy-1,2-ethanediyl), alpha-(nonylphenyl)-omega-hydroxy-, branched	1 2	*alkylphenol ethoxylate*
Poly (oxy-1,2-ethanediyl), alpha-(octylphenyl)-omega-hydroxy-, branched	1 2	*alkylphenol ethoxylate*
Polyacrylamide	1	**Watch for: "*-acrylamide*"** *acrylamide*
Polyethylene	6	
Polyethylene glycol	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *(PEG)- #*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polyethylene glycol 4-(tert- octylphenyl) ether	1 2	*alkylphenol ethoxylate*
Polyethylene glycol mono(octyl)phenyl ether	1 2	*alkylphenol ethoxylate*
Polyethyleneimine Alkoxylated	1	*Alkoxylate; ethylene oxide*
Polyglyceryl-3 beeswax	LOW TOX	
Polyglyceryl-3 diisostearate	LOW TOX	
Polyglyceryl-3 stearate	LOW TOX	
Polyglyceryl-4 caprate	LOW TOX	
Polyhydroxystearic acid	LOW TOX	
Polymeric blue	1	
Polymeric red	1	
Polymethyl methacrylate	1 4 6	
Polymethylsilsesquioxane	2	*PFAS treated*
Polyoxyalkylene Substituted Chromophore	1	*azo dye*
Polyoxymethylene urea	1 2 4 5	*Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polypropylene	6	
Polypropylene glycol	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *(PPG)-#*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polyquaternium-9	1 2	**Watch for: *-nium*** *Acrylamide*
Polysilicone	6	
Polysorbate 20	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *Polysorbate- (#)*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polysorbate 21	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *Polysorbate- (#)*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polysorbate 40	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *Polysorbate- (#)*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polysorbate 60	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *Polysorbate- (#)*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polysorbate 61	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *Polysorbate- (#)*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polysorbate 65	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *Polysorbate- (#)*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polysorbate 80	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *Polysorbate- (#)*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polysorbate 81	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *Polysorbate- (#)*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polysorbate 85	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *Polysorbate- (#)***

Polysorbate 85	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *Polysorbate- (#)*** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Polytetrafluoroethylene	1 2	*PFAS*
Polyurethane	1 6	**Watch for: *Polyurethane - #*** *isocyanate (potential human carcinogen)*
Polyvinyl alcohol	6	
Polyvinylpyrrolidone	1	**Watch for: "*Vinyl-*"** *formaldehyde, acetaldehyde*
Potassium Alum	3	**Watch for: *Contains aluminum*** *Aluminum*
Potassium cocoate	LOW TOX	
Potassium hydroxide	4	
Potassium oleate	LOW TOX	
Potassium olivate	LOW TOX	
Potassium sorbate	LOW TOX	
PPG-2 methyl ether	1 4 5	**Watch for: *PPG- #*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Propanediol	4	
Propylene glycol	1 2	**Watch for: *-glycol***
Propylparaben	2 4	
Protease	LOW TOX	
Pulegone	1 8	**Watch for: *(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum***
PVP/VA copolymers	1 4 6	
Pyridine	1 8	**Watch for: *(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum***
Quaternary ammonium compound	1	**Watch for: "*MEA*"** *Amines*
Quaternium #	2 4	**Watch for: *-nium***
Quaternium-15	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: "*Quaternium- #*" *or* "*- nium*"** *Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Resorcinol	1 2	
Resveratrol	LOW TOX	
Rice Bran Wax	LOW TOX	
Rosemary Extract	LOW TOX	
Saccharide Isomerate	LOW TOX	
Salicylic acid	LOW TOX	
Silica	1 2	**Watch for: *Hydrated silica is acceptable*** *PFAS treated*
Silica (hydrated)	LOW TOX	
Silica Silylate	1 2	*PFAS treated*
Sodium anisate	LOW TOX	
Sodium benzoate	LOW TOX	
Sodium bicarbonate (baking soda)	LOW TOX	
Sodium Borate	2	
Sodium c10-16 alkylbenzenesulfonate	7	
Sodium carbonate	LOW TOX	

Sodium carbonate peroxide	LOW TOX	
Sodium chloride (table salt)	LOW TOX	
Sodium citrate	LOW TOX	
Sodium Coco-Sulfate	4 5	**Watch for: "*-sulfate*"** *Contains Sodium Laurel Sulfate*
Sodium cocoate	LOW TOX	
Sodium Cocoyl Alaninate	LOW TOX	
Sodium Cocoyl Isethionate	1	*1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Sodium cumenesulfonate	4	
Sodium Dodecyl Sulfate	1 4 5	**Watch for: "*-sulfate*"** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Sodium gluconate	LOW TOX	
Sodium hyaluronate	LOW TOX	
Sodium hydroxymethylglycinate	1 2 4 5	*Formaldehyde; 1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Sodium hypochlorite	4 7 8	*Same as bleach*
Sodium iminodisuccinate	LOW TOX	
Sodium Laurel Sulfate	1 4 5	**Watch for: "*-sulfate*"** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Sodium Laureth Sulfate	1 4 5	**Watch for: "*-sulfate*"** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Sodium Lauryl Sulfate	1 4 5	**Watch for: "*-sulfate*"** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Sodium levulinate	LOW TOX	
Sodium olivoyl glutamate	LOW TOX	
Sodium palmate	LOW TOX	
Sodium phytate	LOW TOX	
Sodium pyrithione	7	*antimicrobial*
Sorbeth-2 beeswax	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *-eth*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Sorbeth-2 cocoate	1 2 4 5	**Watch for: *-eth*** *1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Sorbic acid	LOW TOX	
Sorbitan oleate	LOW TOX	
Sorbitan oleate decylglucoside crosspolymer	LOW TOX	
Sorbitan olivate	LOW TOX	
Sorbitan palmitate	LOW TOX	
Squalane	LOW TOX	
Stearalkonium chloride	2	**Watch for: *-nium***
Stearamide MEA	1 4	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
Stearyl alcohol	LOW TOX	
Styrenated Phenol Ethoxylate	1 2	*1,4-dioxane, ethylene oxide*
Styrene/acrylates copolymer	1 4 6	*Styrene, acrylates*
Subtilisin	LOW TOX	*Enyme; Avoid in powdered products*

Sucrose Cocoate	LOW TOX	
Synthetic Fluorphlogopite	1 2	**Watch for: "*-fluoro-*"** *PFAS treated*
Talc	1 2	*PFAS treated*
TEA-Lauryl Sulfate	1 4	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
tetradecyl aminobutyroylvalylaminobutyric urea trifluoroacetate	1 2	**Watch for: "*-fluoro-*"** *PFAS*
Tetrahexyldecyl Ascorbate	LOW TOX	**Watch for: "*ascorbate*" *(vitamin C)***
Tetrasodium Edta	1	**Watch for: *EDTA*** *formaldehyde*
Tocopherol (Vitamin E)	LOW TOX	
Toluene	1	**Watch for: "*toluene*"**
Tosylamide/Epoxy Resin	4	
Totarol	LOW TOX	
Toxalide (AHTN)	1 4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"** *Musk-type compound*
Traseolide (ATII)	1 4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"** *Musk-type compound*
Tribehenin	LOW TOX	
Triethanolamine (TEA)	1 4	**Watch for: *-EA*** *Nitrosamines*
Triethyl citrate	LOW TOX	
trifluoropropyl cyclopentasiloxane	1 2	*PFAS, synthetic silicone*
trifluoropropyl cyclotetrasiloxane	1 2	*PFAS, synthetic silicone*
Triheptanoin	LOW TOX	
Trimethylsiloxysilicate	1 2	**Watch for: "*-siloxy-*"** *PFAS treated, synthetic silicone*
Tripropylene glycol n-butyl ether	4	**Watch for: "*-glycol*"**
Trisodium citrate	LOW TOX	
Trisodium dicarboxymethyl alaninate	LOW TOX	
Trisodium Ethylenediamine Disuccinate	LOW TOX	
Vanillin	4 8	**Watch for: "*(Natural) Fragrance or Parfum*"**
Vinyl chloride	1	**Watch for: "*Vinyl-*"** *acrylamide, vinyl formamide*
Vinylpyrrolidone	1	**Watch for: "*Vinyl-*"** *acrylamide, vinyl formamide*
VP/Eicosene Copolymer	1 2 6	*PFAS treated*
Walnut Powder	LOW TOX	
White petroleum	1	
Xanthan gum	LOW TOX	
Xylenes	1	
Xylenesulfonate	1	**Watch for: *xylene*** *xylene*
Zeolite	LOW TOX	*Avoid in powdered form*
Zinc oxide (non-nano)	LOW TOX	*Avoid in sprays and aerosols*

The patterns to memorize first

You don't need to memorize 425 ingredients. You need to recognize the **chemical families** they belong to. If you learn these naming patterns, you'll catch 90% of the worst offenders without ever opening this guide.

The five patterns that catch most concerns

-nium	Quaternary ammonium compounds. Cetrimonium chloride, polyquaternium-7, behentrimonium chloride. Endocrine disruptors used in conditioners and styling products.
-eth-	Ethoxylated compounds. Ceteareth-20, sodium laureth sulfate, PEG anything. Contaminated with 1,4-dioxane and ethylene oxide during manufacturing. Carcinogen + microbiome-busting.
-paraben	Methylparaben, propylparaben, butylparaben. Endocrine disruptors that mimic estrogen. Increasingly hidden under "preservative" rebrands.
-glycol	Propylene glycol, butylene glycol, hexylene glycol. Mostly carcinogen + endocrine disruptor flags. Common in lotions, deodorants, kids' products.
Fragrance	Or "Parfum" or "Natural Fragrance." Legally allowed to hide thousands of chemicals including phthalates. The single biggest source of endocrine disruptors in personal care.

Beyond these five, watch for: **siloxanes** (cyclopentasiloxane, dimethicone — silicones with PFAS contamination), **formaldehyde-releasers** (DMDM hydantoin, diazolidinyl urea, quaternium-15), **sulfates** (sodium lauryl sulfate, sodium laureth sulfate — strip the skin barrier), and **petroleum products** (petrolatum, mineral oil, paraffin — carcinogens that block skin's natural function).

> **The bigger picture:** *No one expects you to memorize 425 ingredients. Pick up the products you already own. Read three labels. Spot one of the five patterns above. Replace one product. Then another. The goal isn't a perfect cabinet overnight. The goal is a daughter whose hormones aren't being pushed by the chemicals in her bottle of conditioner. Every swap counts.*